

EMERGENCY ACTION PLAN — DO THIS TODAY

For: Maria Elena Rodriguez

Your deadline is shown on your summons. Do not wait.

IMMEDIATELY — Next 24 Hours

- Find your eviction summons. Look for the DEADLINE DATE and CASE NUMBER.
- Write the deadline on your calendar. Set a phone alarm 2 days BEFORE it.
- Read this entire packet. You will need to understand every document.
- If you can, call a friend or family member. You do not have to do this alone.

NEXT — Within 1-2 Days

- Fill out and SIGN your Answer form (separate PDF). Use blue or black ink.
- Complete your fee waiver form if you cannot afford the filing fee.
- Make 3 copies of EVERYTHING. The court clerk keeps the original.

FILE — Before Your Deadline

- Go to the courthouse in person OR e-file online (see E-Filing Instructions).
- Bring: signed Answer form, fee waiver form, copies of everything, photo ID.
- Ask the clerk to stamp your copies as FILED. Keep one for yourself.
- If filing by mail, use certified mail with return receipt.

AFTER FILING — Serve the Landlord

- Deliver a filed copy to your landlord or their attorney.
- Do this by certified mail, hand delivery, or email (with read receipt).
- Keep PROOF — mail receipt, delivery confirmation, or email screenshot.

PREPARE FOR COURT

- Read the Defenses Explained document to understand your legal options.
- Read the Evidence Guide and start gathering evidence TODAY.
- Review the Hearing Script. Practice saying it out loud.
- Call the rental assistance numbers in this packet. Apply for help immediately.

IF YOU MISS YOUR DEADLINE: The judge may enter a default judgment against you and you could be evicted without a hearing. **THIS IS THE MOST IMPORTANT THING.** File your answer on time.